The Formation of Malaysia



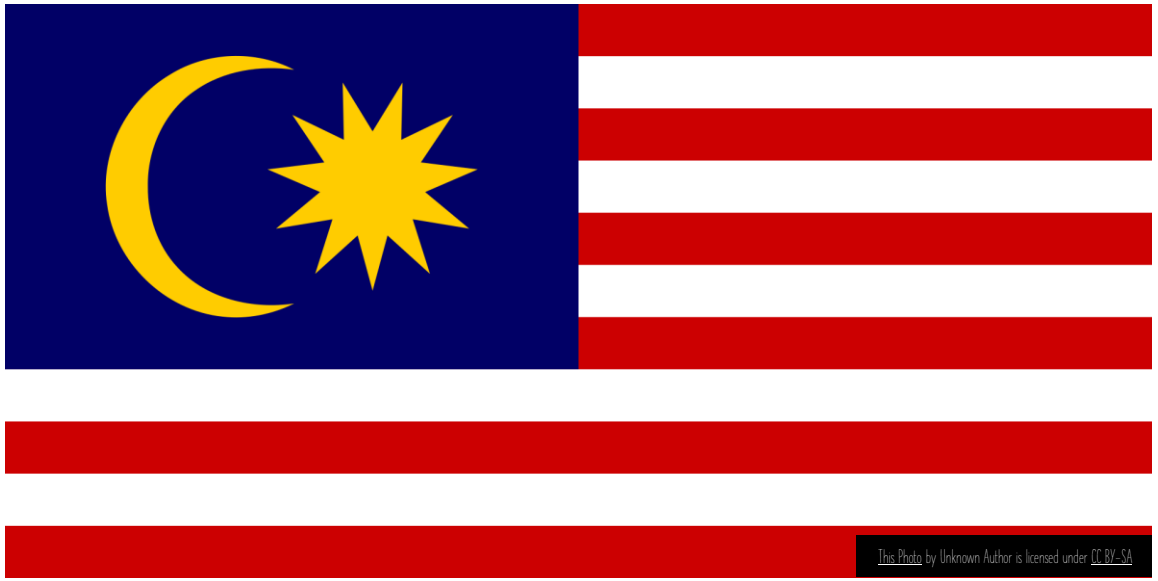
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At the end of this chapter, the student will be able to

Understand behind	Understand behind the movement of the Formation of Malaysia,
Observe	Observe the process of the establishment of Malaysia,
Evaluate	Evaluate the reactions towards the formation of Malaysia by Southeast Asia neighbouring states and also Sabah and Sarawak,
Explain	Explain the issues arise brought forward by Singapore and Brunei along the formation process.

Introduction

- Malaysia's sovereignty is recognized by the international community, it is currently in the right path to keep on developing its economy.
- Politically speaking, it is a state that practices Parliamentary Democracy which shows its political stability.
- The uniqueness of Malaysia apart from its location, culturally it is a multi-ethnic and multi-religious society whereby the community live in a peaceful and harmonious life.
- The unity in diversity slogan shows the real essence of Malaysian society, different ethnics work hand-in-hand to achieve for the best.
- The formation of Malaysia is one of the process need to be understand by Malaysians and others in order to understand the formation of this unique society,



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From Federation of Malaya to Malaysia

- Malaysia was formerly known as Federation of Malaya from 1st February 1948 until 16th September 1963.
- The federation consists of nine Malay states and two British Straits Settlements.
- The federation gained its independence in 31st August 1957 and it is considered as the official independent day for the federation as well as Malaysia.
- However, strong consolidated union among the federation and Singapore, Sabah, Sarawak and Brunei deems very much important to establish a sovereign state in the region.

THE ESTABLISHMENT OF MALAYSIA
SEPT 16, 1963



1

MAY 27, 1961
Prime Minister Tunku Abdul Rahman, during the Southeast Asian Foreign Correspondents Association Conference at Hotel Adelphi, Singapore, had established the need for a plan to bring the Federation of Malaya, Singapore, Sabah, Sarawak and Brunei into a form of political cooperation.

2

JULY 23, 1961
The Commonwealth Parliamentary Association, Malaya and Borneo Branch Meeting in Singapore, agreed to set up a Malaysian Unity Consultative Committee chaired by Donald Stephen.

3

AUG 1961
The first meeting of the Malaysian Unity Consultative Committee was held in Sabah.

4

DEC 18 - 20, 1961
The second meeting of the Malaysian Unity Consultative Committee was held in Kuching, Sarawak.

5



JAN 6 & 7, 1962
The third meeting of the Malaysian Unity Consultative Committee was held at the Selangor Legislative Assembly chamber in Kuala Lumpur.

6



JAN 17, 1962
The Cobbold Commission was set up to look at the views of the population in northern Borneo (Sabah) and Sarawak. The Commission comprised five members, namely, Lord Cobbold, Datuk Wong Pow Nee, Mohd Ghazali Shafie, Sir Anthony Abell & Sir David Watherson. Mr H. Harris acted as secretary.

7

FEB 3 & 4, 1962
The fourth meeting of the Malaysian Unity Consultative Committee.

8



JUNE 21, 1962
The Cobbold Commission Report was completed & submitted to the British Government & Federal Government of Malaya.

9

JULY 1962
An agreement was reached by the Prime Minister of the Federation of Malaya, Tunku Abdul Rahman and British Prime Minister, Harold Macmillan to hold talks.

10



JULY 9, 1963
The agreement on the establishment of the Federation of Malaysia was signed at the Commonwealth Liaison Office in Marlborough House, London. It was signed by representatives of the British government, Federation of Malaya, Sabah, Sarawak and Singapore.

11



SEPT 16, 1963
The ceremony to mark the formation of Malaysia was held at Merdeka Stadium, Kuala Lumpur. The declaration of the formation was read by Prime Minister Tunku Abdul Rahman



The idea behind the formation of Malaysia

- The idea came from the first Prime Minister of the Federation of Malaya, Tunku Abdul Rahman in 27 March 1961.
- His motivation behind it was to establish a economic and political alliance with Singapore, Sabah, Sarawak and Brunei.
- He realised to achieve the targeted inspiration for this region, cooperation in politics, economics and cultural among these states were essential, likewise strong cooperation with the British.
- Before coming out with the idea, Tunku Abdul Rahman had already met the leaders in the respective areas which were
- - Lee Kuan Yew (Singapore)
- -Senu Abdul Rahman (Borneo Island)
- -Harold MacMichael (British)

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Factors Affecting Malaysia's Formation

- Independence through Unification
- Through this unification, the other four states which are Sabah, Sarawak, Brunei and Singapore can achieve their independent from British.
- It will accelerate the independence for all the states involved in the idea of Malaysia.
- Understanding for development
- Enable to foster regional understanding and creating one united nation for the progress of the country and the people.
- One central administration will easily develop the existing potential in any of the country.

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- Economic Cooperation
- The economic potential in a state could be further developed if it was administered from a central government following the member states.
- Collective fight against internal and external threats
- By merging and granting Independence to these territories, the enemies could be easily defeated
- Ethnic Balance and Unity
- The entrance of Sabah & Sarawak will balance the population; between Bumiputera & non- Bumiputera.
- The balance composition of the society will guarantee political stability and peaceful relations among them.

The Formation Process

- The Malaysia Solidarity Consultative Committee (MSCC)
- July 1961- The leaders of the Federation of Malaya and Singapore took the opportunity to explain the concept of Malaysia to the representatives from Sabah, Sarawak and Brunei.
- It involves every parties in the formation.
- This committee also the place whereby they obtain mutual agreement from political leaders of the regions.





The Cobbold Commission



CC

- Also known as The North Borneo Commission of Enquiry (16 January 1962)
- Members of Cobbold Commission: Lord Cobbold, Anthony Abell, David Waterson, Dato' Wong Pow Nee, Tan Sri Mohd Ghazali Shafie.
- Objectives of CC
- -Seek sentiments and opinion of the people in North Borneo and Sarawak
- -Make recommendations after hearing the opinions
- CC held meetings across Sabah and Sarawak, accepting memorandum from various background of people.

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Results of CC

- Ended on 18 April 1962
- 80% of Sabahans and Sarawakians were supporting the formation
- Results:
- 1/3 Fully supports
- 1/3 Conditional supports
- 1/3 Demand independent before entering Malaysia



Inter-governmental Committee (IGC)

- Established in August 1962.
- Headed by Lord Lansdowne and assisted by Tunku Abdul Rahman
- The task of this committee was to legislate law based on the draft prepared by the Cobbold Commission.

The Main Core of the Constitution

- Islam was to be the official religion of the federation of Malaysia, Except in Sabah and Sarawak
- Bahasa Melayu was the official language of the Federation of Malaysia, but FLEXIBILTY was given to Sabah and Sarawak to use English in official matters up to 10 years after the formation.
- State government of Sabah and Sarawak would retain control of immigration, but the budget allocation would be under the control of the central government.
- The education system would be sustained.
- The division of Parliamentary seats among Sabah, Sarawak and Singapore.


Singapore
Referendum

- To survey the opinions of Singaporeans
- This consensus found that 71% of Singaporeans agreed to Malaysia's formation via option A.

- Singaporean were given three options, which were:

(a) The people agree to participate in the affiliation according to terms set by the governments of Singapore and Federation of Malaya in the November 1961 White Paper (overall, generated 397,626 votes)

(b) The people agree to participate in the affiliation unconditionally and Singapore would be of similar status as the Malay States in the federation of Malaya; overall, this option garnered 94,442 votes

(c) The people agree to participate in the affiliation provided Singapore was offered similar terms and benefits as enjoyed by the participating nations of Borneo; overall it garnered 144,077 votes

The Reactions

Sarawak

- **Support**
  Parti Barisan Rakyat Jati Sarawak (BERJASA)
- **Against**
  Parti Negara Sarawak (PANAS)
  Sarawak United People's Party (SUPP)
  Sarawak National Party (SNAP)







Sabah

- Support

  United Sabah National Organization (USNO)
- Against

  United National Kadazan Organization (UNKO)

  Pasok Momogun Kebangsaan Borneo Utara

  Brunei People's Party



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Brunei

- **Support**
  Sultan of Brunei and the rakyat in the beginning
- **Against**
  Brunei People's Party

Singapore

- **Support**
  Lee Kuan Yew and People Action Party (PAP)

- **Against**
  United People's Party and Labour Party





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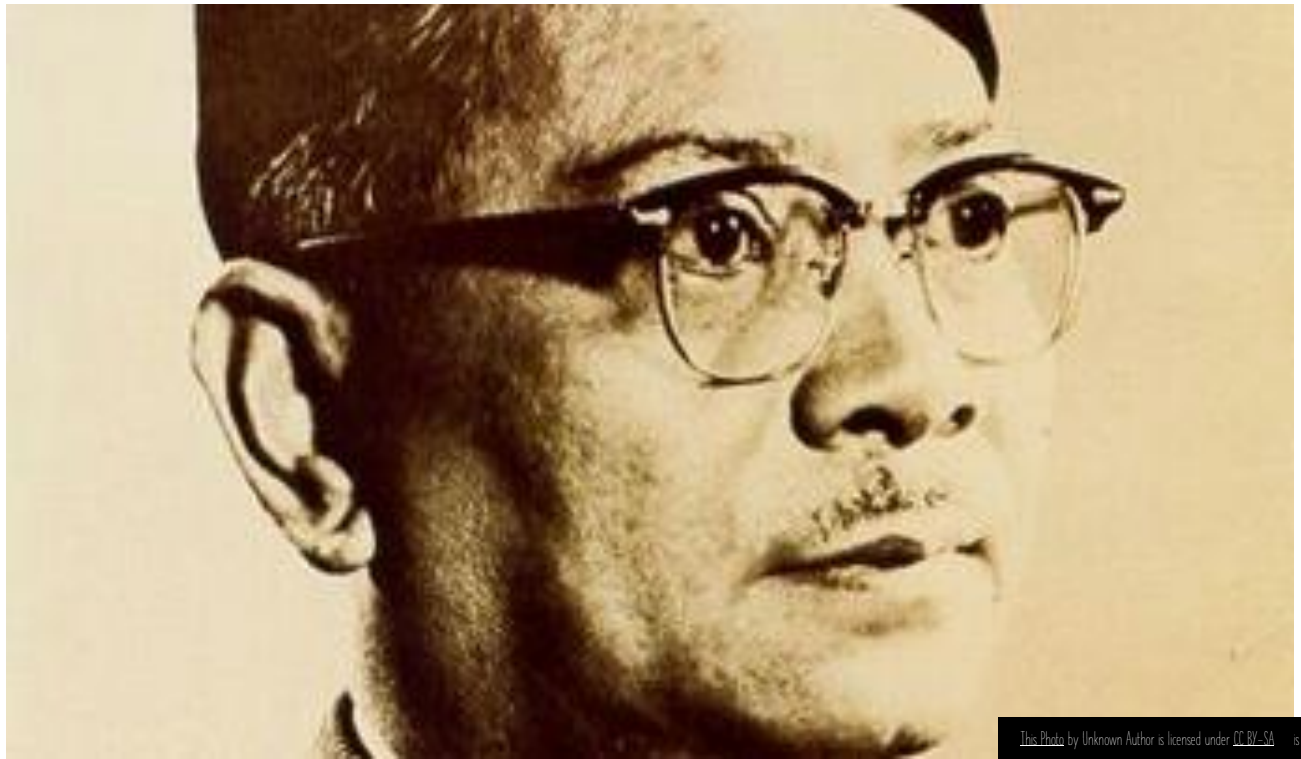


External Reactions

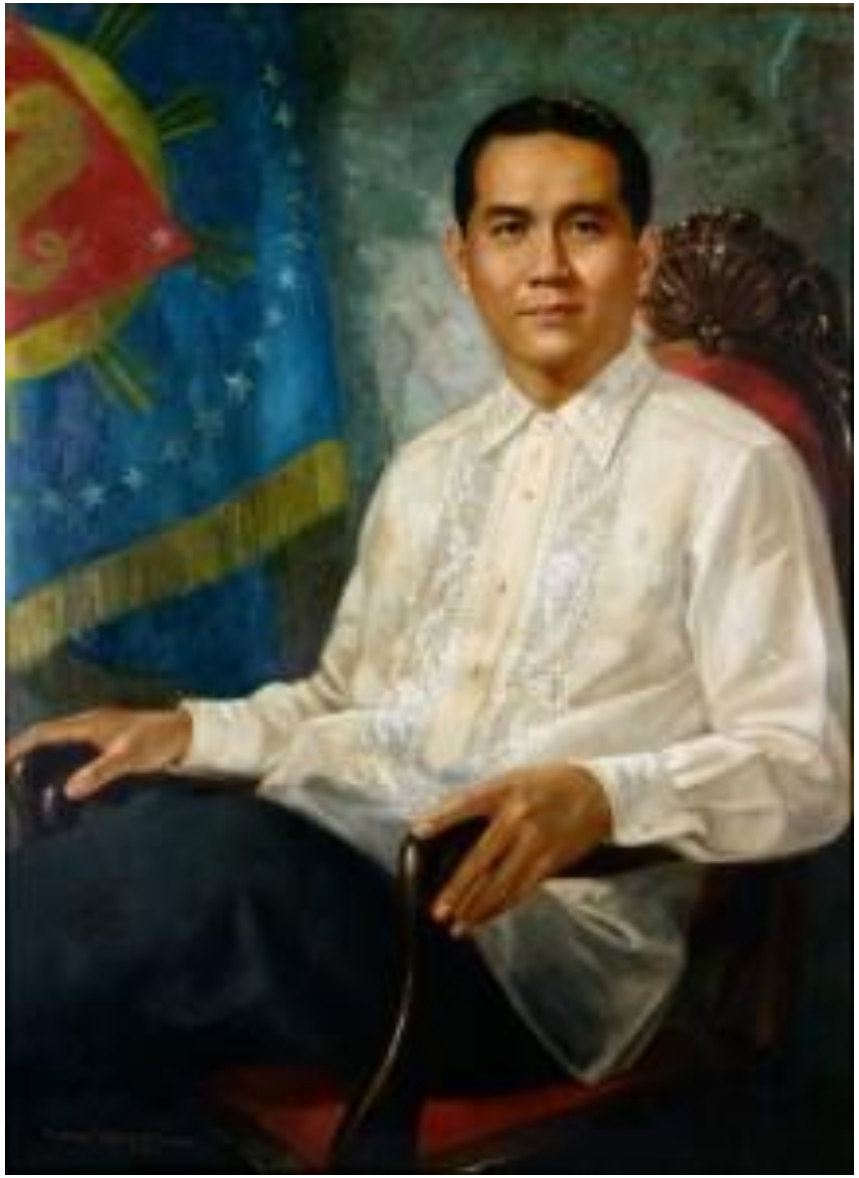
- Indonesia
- 13 November 1961-Indonesian Foreign Minister had no objections and prayed for the success of Malaysia.
- 11 February 1963- President Sukarno announced his confrontation policy of 'Ganyang Malaysia' (Crush Malaysia)
- Reasons
- 1. Malaysia is the neo-colonialism efforts to control natural resources in Malaya.
- 2. Tunku Abdul Rahman did not consult Sukarno before coming out with the idea.
- 1965- Confrontation ended-Sukarno toppled by Suharto.

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- The Philippines
- President Macapagal and high-ranking officials believes Sabah is rightfully theirs
- Demand British returned Sabah to them (22 June 1962 letter)
- It was Sulu Sultanate region
- President Macapagal openly criticized the formation during the Philippines' congress on 28 January 1963.


Gambar: Pusat Sejarah Brunei

Issues with Brunei and Singapore

- Br u n ei
- - The Brunei's Sultan Omar Ali Saifuddin initially agreed by later withdrawing from the arrangement.
- -The reasons behind that were:
- 1. Brunei demands for 10 seats in the Parliament
- 2. Full control over Brunei's oil resources
- 3. Autonomy in financial matters

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- 4. Retention of all its investments
- 5. Retention of low tax rates
- 6. Continuation of its education and welfare programs
- 7. Explicit guarantee of security
- 8. Seniority of Sultan Brunei.

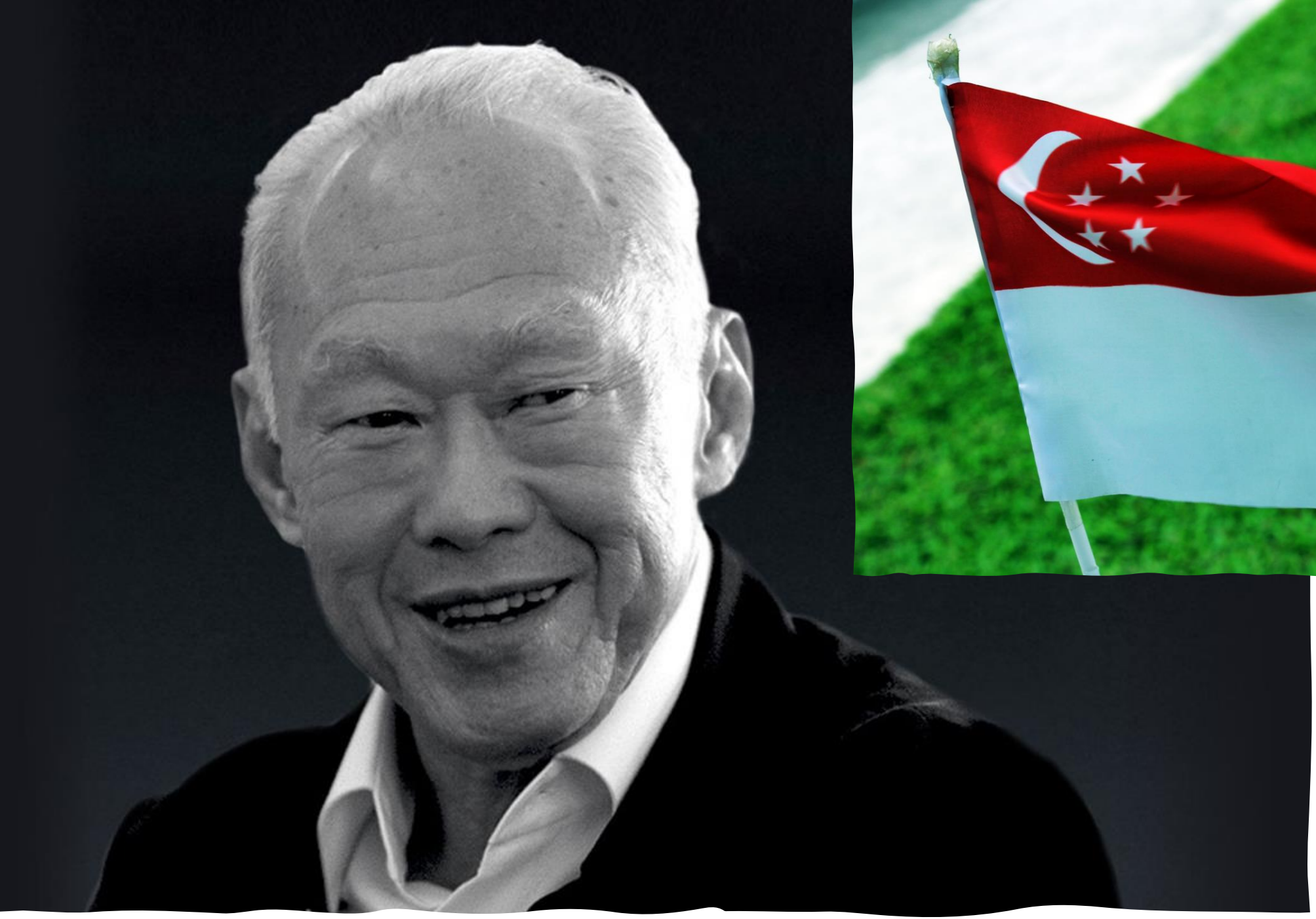
Proclamation of Malaysia 1963



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Singapore

- Two years after Singapore joined Malaysia, the problem of polarization between Malays and Chinese rose. The mediums of the conflict were People Action Party (PAP) and Alliance Party.
- The first election of the Malaysian Federation Parliament was held in 1964 and initiated the split relationship between Singapore and Kuala Lumpur.
- There are numerous effort were made by Tunku Abdul Rahman to resolve these issue, but he was unsuccessful.
- **On 9 August 1965, Singapore separated from Malaysia to become an independent and sovereign state.**





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Thank You